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Solution: Ensure that values are properly formatted before passing them to functions.

```
try:
    num = int("123")
except ValueError:
    num = 0  # Default value
```

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Resources for Further Learning

1. Official Python Documentation

The official Python documentation is the most reliable resource for learning Python and understanding its functions and libraries.

- Python Documentation

2. Books

- **"Automate the Boring Stuff with Python" by Al Sweigart**: This book is great